



WHO Guidelines for Infant Feeding (2025)

- **Initiation and Breastfeeding:**
 - Initiate breastfeeding within *1 hour of birth*.
 - Practice *exclusive breastfeeding* for the first 6 months of life.
 - After 6 months, introduce *nutritionally adequate and safe complementary foods* while continuing breastfeeding up to 2 years of age or beyond. ^{[1] [2] [3]}
- **Key Recommendations:**
 - Exclusive breastfeeding for six months.
 - Complementary feeding starts at six months.
 - Continued breastfeeding up to at least two years.
 - For infants born to HIV-infected mothers, antiretroviral drugs now allow for exclusive breastfeeding until six months and continued up to 12 months, under medical guidance. ^[1]
- **Complementary Feeding (6–23 Months):**
 - Diversify diet; emphasize use of broad food groups.
 - Replace milk (other than breast milk) with *animal milk or infant formula after 6 months*.
 - After 12 months, young children should receive animal milk if breast milk is not provided. ^{[4] [5]}

Source Metadata (WHO)

- Official factsheet: [WHO Infant and Young Child Feeding, Dec 19, 2023] ^[1]
- Comprehensive guideline: ["WHO Guideline for complementary feeding of infants and young children 6–23 months of age", Oct 15, 2023] ^{[2] [5] [4]}

RIVM (Netherlands) Guidelines

- **Dutch Updates:**
 - In 2025, the Health Council of the Netherlands (advisory body to RIVM) is developing updated dietary recommendations for infants up to two years as part of the "Healthy nutrition: the first thousand days" initiative.
 - Prior guidance covers recommendations for pregnant and lactating women, with updated infant guidelines expected late 2025. ^[6]
- **Specifics Mentioned:**

- Upcoming guidance will cover sources of protein, reference values for carbohydrates, fats, and fatty acids for infants.
- Vitamin K administration: Newborns are given vitamin K (preferably via intramuscular injection, with oral as alternative) to prevent deficiency-related hemorrhage, especially for those with disturbed fat absorption.^[6]

Source Metadata (RIVM / Dutch Health Council)

- Report (expected late 2025): "Dietary recommendations for infants up to two years of age"^[6]
- Latest details: Work programme 2025 Health Council of the Netherlands (published Sep 17, 2024)^[6]

Summary Table

Guideline Body	Key Recommendations	Latest Publication	Metadata Summary
WHO	Early breastfeeding (1 hr); exclusive breastfeeding (6 mo); complementary feeding at 6 mo; continued breastfeeding (2 yrs+); diet diversity for 6-23 mo; safe formula/animal milk use if needed	Dec 2023 / Oct 2023	Fact sheet ^[1] , guidelines ^{[2] [4] [5]}
RIVM / Health Council NL	Vitamin K for newborns; dietary recommendations for infants up to 2 yrs; update expected late 2025	Work programme Sep 2024	Details in Health Council report ^[6]

Direct guideline links and references:

- WHO factsheet:^[1]
- WHO full guideline:^{[5] [2] [4]}
- Dutch Health Council (RIVM-related):^[6]

All recommendations above align closely with current global best practices.^{[2] [4] [5] [1] [6]}

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1. <https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/infant-and-young-child-feeding>
2. <https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789240081864>
3. <https://www.paho.org/en/topics/breastfeeding-and-complementary-feeding>
4. [https://www.espghan.org/dam/jcr:39d33674-9750-4138-a919-b4bf07808835/WHO Statement.pdf](https://www.espghan.org/dam/jcr:39d33674-9750-4138-a919-b4bf07808835/WHO%20Statement.pdf)
5. <https://iris.who.int/bitstream/handle/10665/373358/9789240081864-eng.pdf>
6. <https://www.healthcouncil.nl/binaries/healthcouncil/documenten/other/2024/09/17/work-programme-2025/Work-programme-2025-Health-Council-of-the-Netherlands.pdf>
7. https://apps.who.int/iris/bitstream/handle/10665/44117/9789241597494_eng.pdf
8. https://ashfordstpeters.net/Guidelines_Maternity/Infant-Feeding-Policy-Jan-2025.pdf

9. <https://www.sochob.cl/web1/wp-content/uploads/2023/10/WHO-Guideline-for-complementary-feeding-of-infants-and-young-children-6-23-months-of-age.pdf>
10. <https://www.rivm.nl/en/news/changes-in-childhood-vaccination-schedule-for-2025>